

# Is ChatGPT bad for the environment like AI generated images are?

Posted by u/Fairy-Styles1999 • 0 points • 15 comments

Do they both give off a lot of carbon emissions? I'm against AI generated imagery because of the environmental factors and also because it's trained on the work of artists without their consent, but is ChatGPT also unethical?

Don't give me any of that "ai art is real art" because it isn't. It steals work from real artists (Digital, traditional, etc)

## Comments

u/AI\_optimist • 1 points • 2024-10-08 16:48 UTC

no... generating images does not create a lot of carbon emissions.

Training neural nets in massive datacenters uses up a lot of energy for the several months that they are training that AI.

To generate an image requires the same energy as 1 second of gameplay on a PlayStation 4/5

To generate text uses the same energy as a google search

That's why both of those can be done on consumer PCs

u/Fairy-Styles1999 • 1 points • 2024-10-08 20:46 UTC

My bad. I don't know where I got carbon emissions from. I was pretty tired when I wrote that. What I meant was energy used. And a lot of fresh water resources are used. It's undeniable that generative AI is bad for the environment.

u/AI\_optimist • 1 points • 2024-10-08 20:59 UTC

What I had said still applies. The energy issues are a part of the training process and not an issue after the model is finished training and in use.

Since using a lot of energy also costs a lot of money, there are now capitalist reasons to invest in energy efficient hardware for AI training/inference and renewable/low carbon energy generation methods like solar, hydro, nuclear, etc.

I agree it's unfortunate that gen-AI had to rely on inefficient hardware and logistics to

get started, which is undoubtedly bad for the environment. But to assume it \*\*\*has to\*\*\* be that bad and that people aren't working to rapidly fix those issues is short sighted.

**u/RandomBitFry** • 0 points • 2024-10-08 14:59 UTC

It's not just the generation of content that uses power, think of the thousands of people using a phone or whatever to view it.

**u/Orangeshowergal** • 0 points • 2024-10-08 14:56 UTC

Chatgpt is an ai. All ai uses power. All electricity production is "bad" for the environment. Some are better, but none maintain or lessen the effect they have on the planet

**u/anti-beep** • 0 points • 2024-10-08 11:59 UTC

In my experience, both types of tech demand really power-hungry systems (at least for cutting-edge stuff).

It's an educated guess, but if they're not about equal in resource-usage then text-generation is likely \*more\* draining than image-generation.

**u/BeneficientWanderer** • 1 points • 2024-10-08 11:59 UTC

1. It uses a lot of energy yes, though this is true for most large computer systems/networks.
2. There are AI models that train exclusively on public-domain works, or works that they possess a licence for. Don't let a few unethical corporations taint your view of an entire technology.

**u/Fairy-Styles1999** • 1 points • 2024-10-08 20:48 UTC

Unfortunately, I can't in good conscience advocate for a service that generally does use the work of real artists. Especially when the service has no real value.

**u/BeneficientWanderer** • 1 points • 2024-10-09 08:37 UTC

So you're presumably also opposed to ink/laser printers, 3D printers, photoshop, and all other forms of digital tools that automate significant parts of the traditional artistic process?

The mere fact that a human could theoretically create a thing themselves does not make it unethical and devoid of value to develop tools to automate and speed up the process. That's the entire foundation of both the digital and Industrial Revolution.

**u/Fairy-Styles1999** • 0 points • 2024-10-09 11:39 UTC

Lol you act like 3D printing doesn't involve an artist creating a 3D model. 3D printing and photoshop and other forms of digital tools involve an artist and their creative vision. AI generated imagery is just putting in a prompt and receiving a soulless image with no work or hard work put into it

And what the hell are you on about with printers? Printing out an image is not the same thing at ALL as generative AI. You can print anything. Family photos, art you made, etc

**u/BeneficientWanderer** • 1 points • 2024-10-09 14:29 UTC

My point is that you have no actual moral basis for your stance, you're solely piling onto the belief of "If it uses

the AI buzzword, it's evil".

AI is still evil to you when trained entirely on consenting works, so what if I train it exclusively on my own work? What if I don't use "AI" at all and I instead just use a primitive algorithm to blend shapes and colours together?

Where are you drawing the arbitrary line between "evil AI" and the tools as simple as the Fill Bucket tool that smart-fills an entire shape with a colour?

**u/Fairy-Styles1999** • 1 points • 2024-10-09 16:04 UTC

If the artists consent or if it's your own work that's different.

That being said, it's still not great given the environmental factors, which is what this fucking post is about

**u/Lumpy-Notice8945** • -1 points • 2024-10-08 11:57 UTC

> Don't give me any of that "ai art is real art" because it isn't. It steals work from real artists (Digital, traditional, etc)

What has that to do with co2? Or is the goal just to rant about AI in public?

AI does not give off any emissions its software, a program. Computers running need electricity. Electricity can be generated by burning fossil fuel. That can emit co2.

But you can power a computer with solar panels just as well.

**u/Fairy-Styles1999** • 0 points • 2024-10-08 20:48 UTC

Covering all my bases. The amount of people who try to defend generative AI is insane and I didn't want to deal with those comments.

**u/ProperIce2777** • 2 points • 2024-10-08 11:54 UTC

I'm currently in engineering and I've been told by my supervisors AI is very energy intensive to implement on a large scale